

Survey Results

The Future Role of the Enterprise Architect

The role of an enterprise architect is evolving fast and is becoming more valuable and integral to overall business success. Enterprise architecture is a continuous process which affects almost all areas of the organization. This survey catches a snapshot of the enterprise architect's role within the changing business and IT environment today.

Content of the Survey

- Enterprise architecture ►
- Enterprise architecture frameworks ►
- The evolving role of the enterprise architect ►
- Organizational structures of the enterprise architecture team ►
- Education and certification for enterprise architects ►
- Communities for enterprise architects ►



You can use the links above to get directly to the appropriate topic

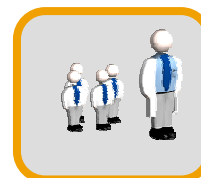
Intention

- Snapshot of enterprise architect's role
- Define the impact of enterprise SOA on the role of the architect
- Consider differences between several industries and company sizes
- The survey was part of the diploma thesis from Sven Feurer.
The thesis was finished in January 2007.
 - Title: "The Impact of Enterprise SOA on the Future Role of the Enterprise Architect."
 - Contact: Sven Feurer, sven.feurer@sap.com



Participants in the Survey

- Attendees to the ASUG enterprise architecture pre-day session on SAP TechEds
 - Las Vegas, 9 September, 2006
 - Amsterdam, 17 October, 2006
- ASUG members who participate in the online survey which was conducted from 1-31 October 2006



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I. General information to the diagrams and the figures

In order to avoid confusion when looking at a diagram, you must be clear about the type of value being reported. In general, you have to differentiate among absolute frequency, relative frequency and mean (see figure 1).

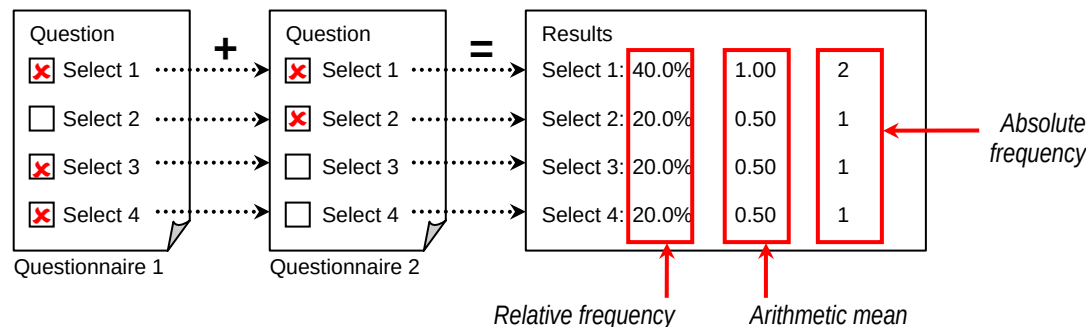


Figure 1: Differences between relative frequencies

- **Absolute frequency:** This value represents the absolute frequency (sum of votes) of an outstanding attribute in a diagram. Looking at absolute frequency is sometimes very helpful in order to define the weighting of an outstanding attribute.

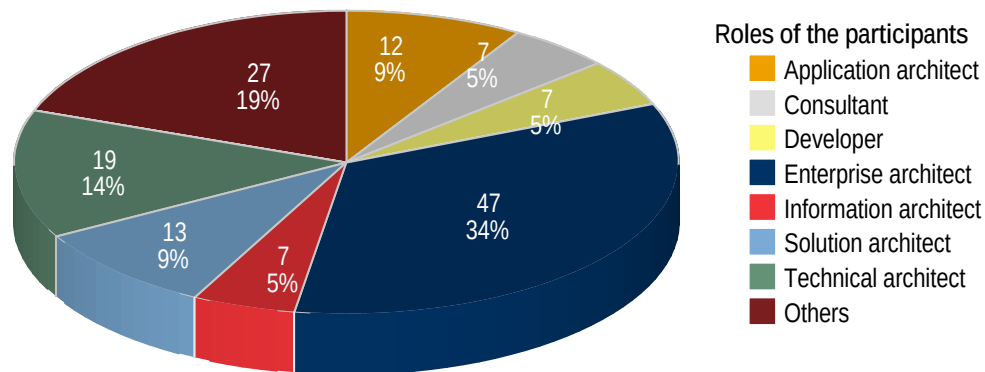
In the example above, the first answer to the question ("Select 1") was chosen by all of the participants. Consequently, this attribute reaches an absolute frequency of 2.

- **Relative frequency:** This frequency is the frequency of an outstanding attribute in relation to other attributes in a statistical unit. An item that was selected by all survey participants does not achieve a relative frequency of 100% when there are other items that also count in this statistical unit.

Referring to the example, the first attribute ("Select 1") was chosen by two participants. Other answers to this question reached an absolute frequency of 3 votes. This means that the first attribute ("Select 1") reaches a relative frequency of 40%.

- **Mean value:** This value is the average of samples in a statistical study. It demonstrates the average weighting of a statistical attribute. Referring to the survey, this parameter is particularly important when questions allow for the selection of multiple items.

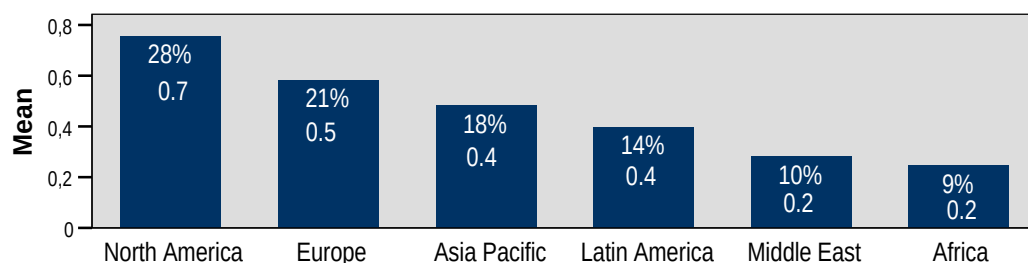
In the example, the first answer to the question was chosen by two participants over two valid questionnaires. Each of these selections was statistically processed with the value "1.00". Consequently, this attribute reaches a mean of 1.00 (meaning that it was selected by 100% of the participants).

Question I.1: Please specify your role in the organization.

Graph 1: Roles of the participants (139 responses)

Summary:

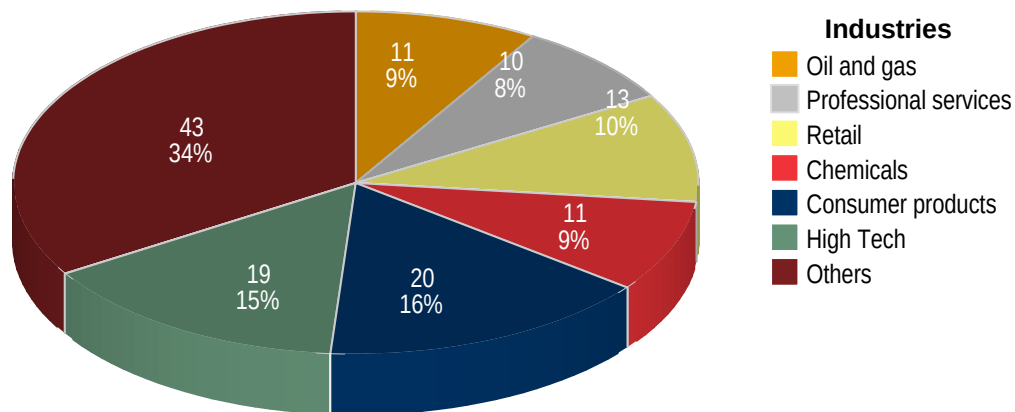
- Enterprise architects represent the largest group of the survey's participants (47 people, 34%).
- The second largest group consists of 19 technical architects (14%).
- This question of the survey allowed participants to choose one role amongst many others. The result is a large group of "Others". However, single roles belonging to this group have not achieved significant quantities.

Question I.2: Please select the geographic region of your company.

Graph 2: Geographic regions (139 responses)

Summary:

- About two thirds of the participants (67%) primarily work for companies located in North America (28%), Europe (21%), and Asia Pacific (18%).
- One third of the people (33%) work for companies based in Latin America (14%), Middle East (10%), and Africa (9%).
- This distribution gives the survey an international character and leads to representative results.

Question I.3: What industry does your business belong to?

Graph 3: Industries in which companies of the participants operate (139 responses)

Summary:

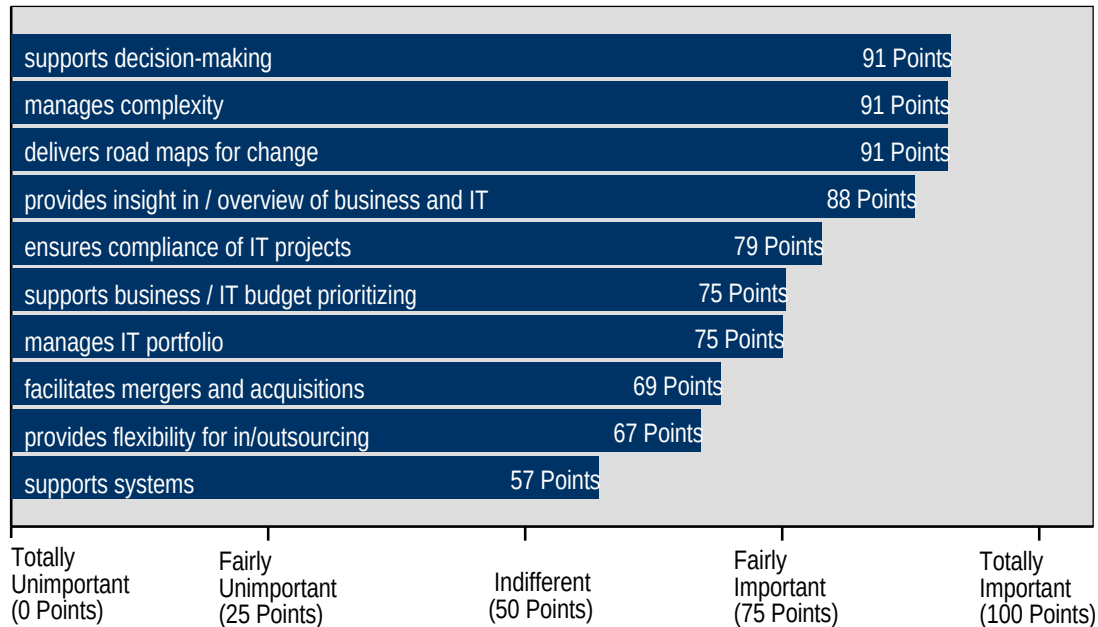
- Most people work in the consumer products industry (16%).
- Other major groups come from the high tech industry (15%) and the retail industry (10%).
- This question of the survey allowed participants to choose one role amongst many others. The result is a large group of "Others". However, single roles belonging to this group have not achieved significant quantities.

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II. Enterprise Architecture

Question II.1: What are characteristics of a future-proof EA?

Enterprise architecture ...



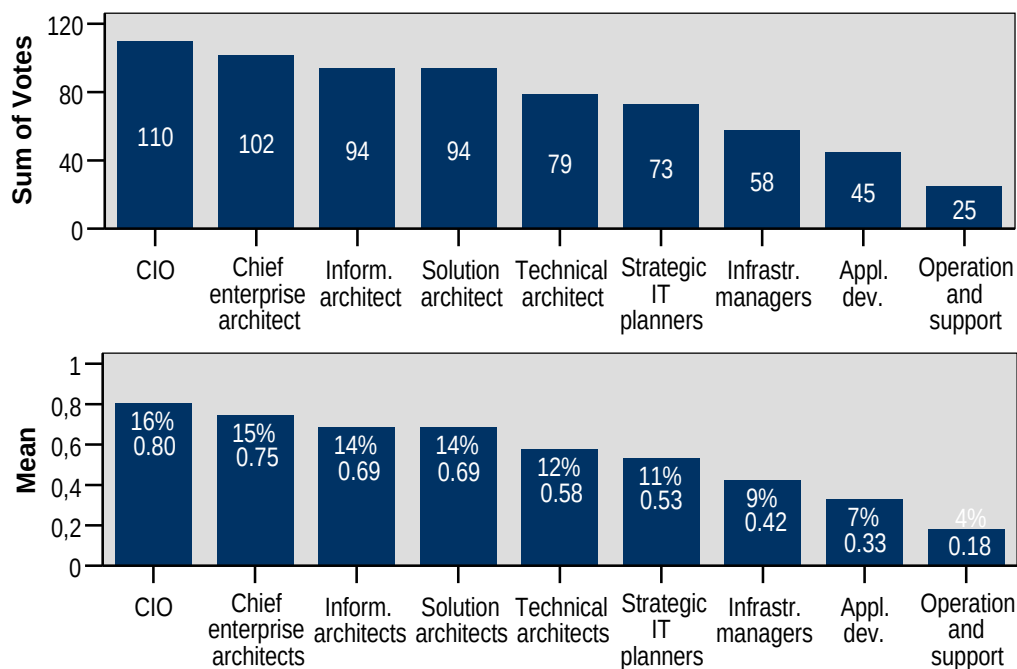
Graph 4: Characteristics of a future-proof enterprise architecture (139 responses)

The results indicate the most crucial advantages of enterprise architecture and the hot topics of enterprise architecture.

Summary:

- **Decision-making (91 points):** Enterprise architecture integrates a set of dimensions (people, processes, information and technologies) and provides the direction and control to align them to strategic IT and business goals. Thus enterprise architecture represents a substantial foundation to make decisions.
- **Complexity (91 points):** An important characteristic of enterprise architecture is to reduce the complexity of the system landscape, for instance by utilizing a top-down approach (see question III.2).
- **Road map (91 points):** The enterprise architecture in itself represents an organizational compass that shows the strategic direction of a company. This compass can be used to provide a clear road map toward a target enterprise architecture.

Other characteristics that are not listed above: enterprise architectures address the governance of the standards processes, provide guidelines and principles for business-relevant IT strategies, serve as tools to communicate the organizational strategies, reduce costs of business solutions and enable business process agility.

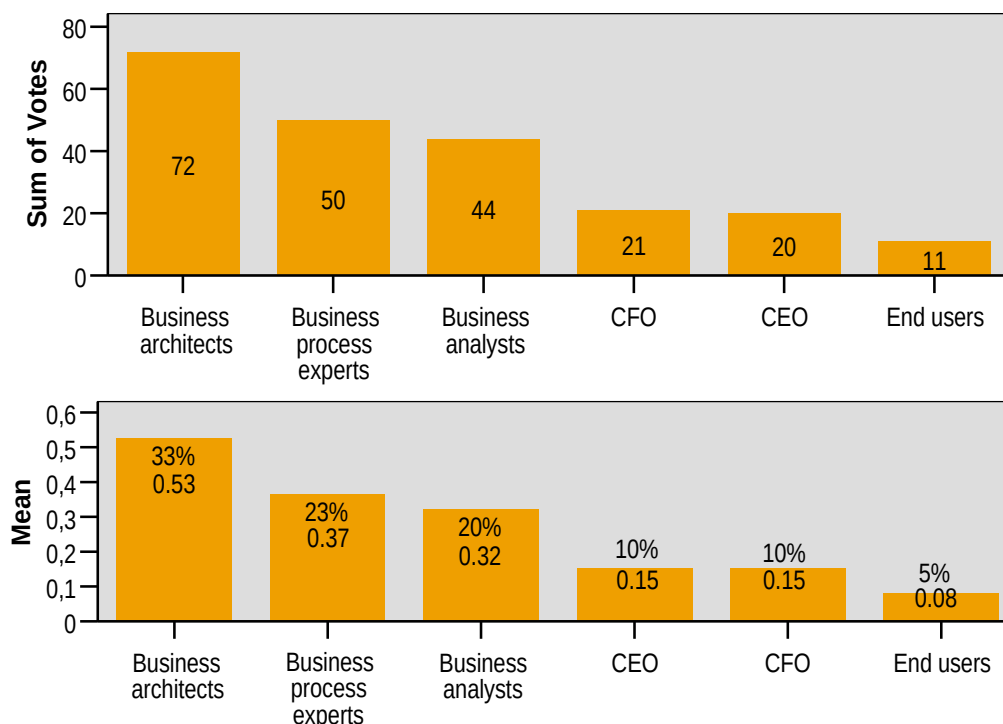
Question II.2: Who cares about EA in your company? - Part 1

Graph 5: EA involvement of the IT community (138 responses)

Summary (IT Community):

- As head of the architecture teams the CIO plays the strongest role (16%). The more strategic enterprise architectures get the more important chief information officers become. This is one of the reasons why many CIOs predict that their job would split into two different roles: one strategic CIO who focuses on business agility and sustainable value creation through technology (let us say the chief process innovation officer) and a tactical CIO whose major goal would be to run an efficient and flexible IT landscape (let us say the chief IT officer)¹.
- Highly involved in enterprise architecture efforts is the architecture team (54%). The enterprise architecture team includes the chief enterprise architect (15%), information architects (14%), solution architects (14%), and technical architects (12%). Business architects, who actually belong to the enterprise architecture team, remain out of consideration because they are assigned to the business community (please see below).
- Less involved are strategic IT planners who plan the IT strategy and the architecture (11%); infrastructure managers that are responsible for the entire IT infrastructure of the organization (9%); application developers who design, develop, and test software modules and applications that support the mission of enterprise architecture (7%); as well as operational and support managers responsible for both reliable data centers and efficient support services (4%).

¹ Source: http://www.cio.com/archive/010106/cio_role.html?page=1

Question II.2: Who cares about EA in your company? - Part 2

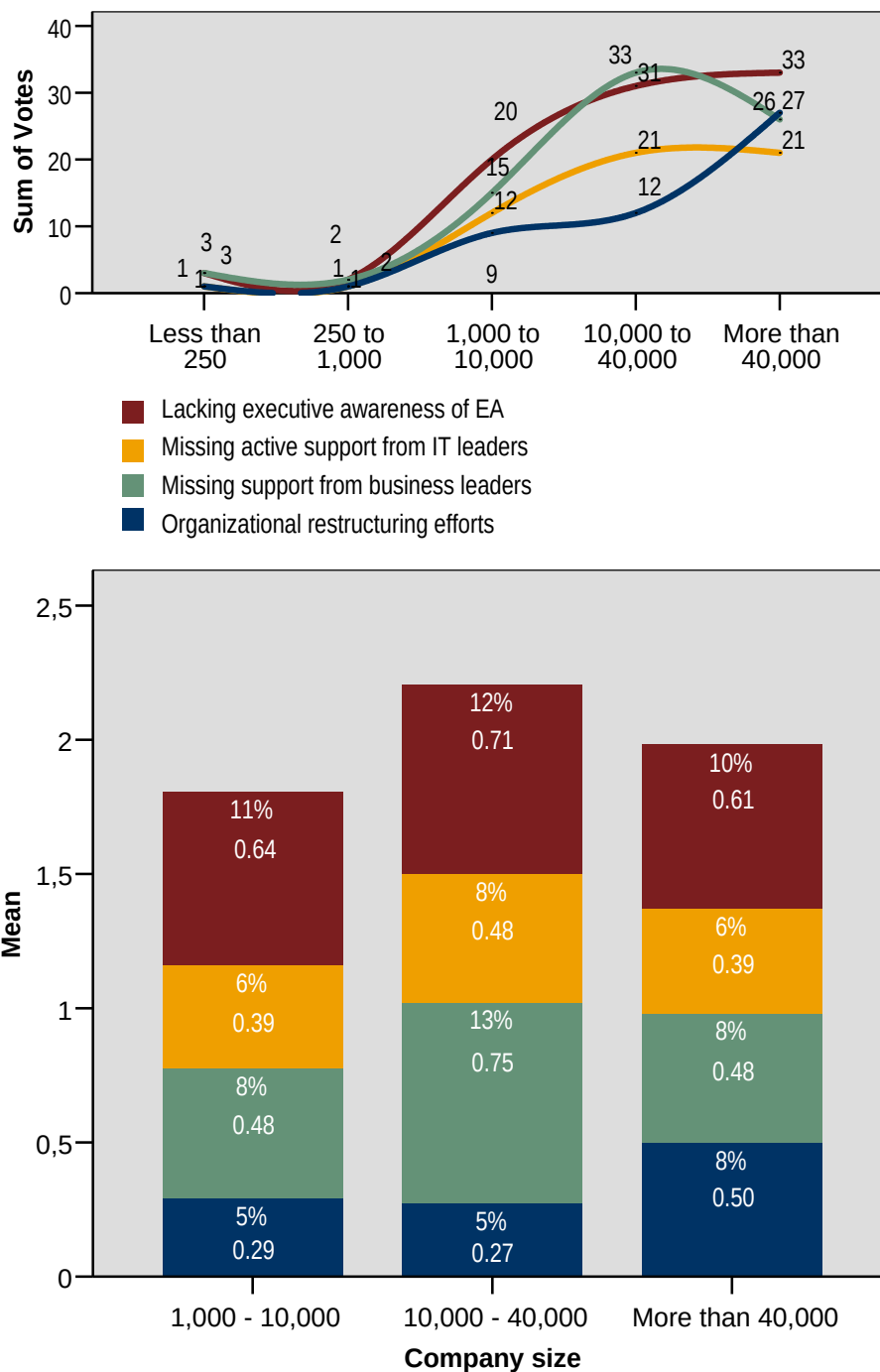
Graph 6: EA involvement of the business community (138 responses)

Summary (Business Community):

- Business architects who also belong to the enterprise architecture team are the strongest business players involved in enterprise architecture efforts (33%).
- Business process experts are both business and IT savvy and understand business processes and the best practices to adapt and improve them. They participate in enterprise architecture projects in reference to the implementation of specific enterprise solutions (23%).
- Business analysts analyze business needs to help identify business problems and propose solutions (20%). The role of business analyst is very close to the role of business process expert. The key differentiator is the clearly more technical nature of the business process expert.
- Both the chief executive officer and the chief financial officer account for 20% of the business community that cares about enterprise architectures.
- End users are less in touch with architectural issues (5%). They are unconcerned about the underlying architecture when they use applications.

Others who care about enterprise architecture: Business partners, project managers, program managers, business consultants, business process owners, and chief technology officers.

Question II.3: What are challenges and issues to overcome on the way to the best-fitting EA?



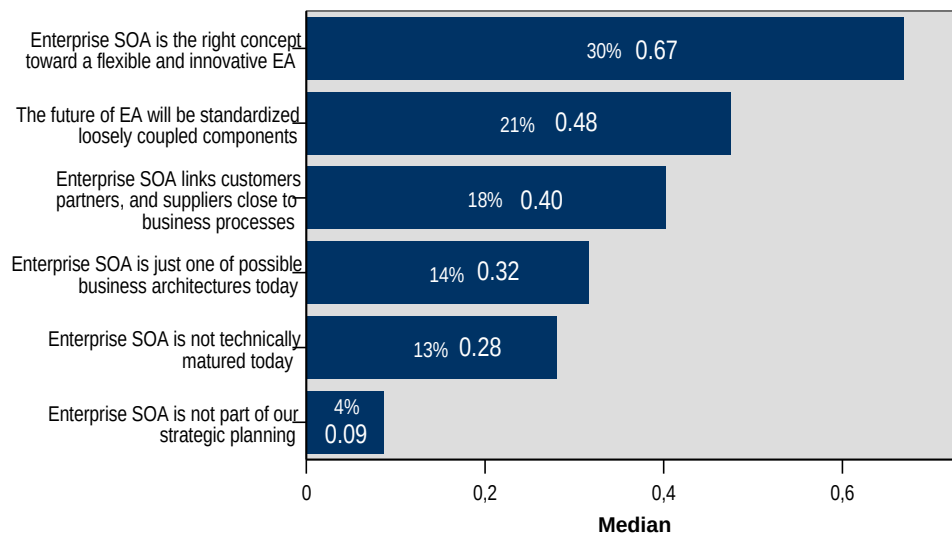
Graph 7: Organizational challenges on the way to a target EA (135 responses)

The question II.3 is used to identify barriers that must be known or even removed in order to prevent the failure of enterprise architecture projects. The diagram (graph 7) shows four important challenges which are generally based on organizational conditions. These challenges are compared to the sizes (number of employees) of the participants' companies. Due to an unrepresentative number of survey participants who work for

companies with less than 1,000 employees the following analysis will only consider companies with more than 1,000 employees, to avoid misleading results.

Summary:

- **Lacking executive awareness (33% of all challenges):** Since enterprise architecture affects nearly every area of the organization it's very important to get sustainable executive support for architectural goals. This represents the greatest challenge for companies with up to 1,000 employees.
- **Missing support from business leaders (29% of all challenges):** While IT provides the technical basis for enterprise architecture it is the business people who generally ensure their acceptance and sustainable success. 75% of companies with 10,000 to 40,000 employees lack the support from business leaders. This is in fact a clear motivation for enterprise architects to improve their liaison to the business units and better involve business people in enterprise architecture related activities.
- **Missing active support from IT leaders (21% of all challenges):** Since the CIO is involved in architectural issues (see question II.2, part 1) IT leaders typically provide their active support for enterprise architecture. However, 48% of the larger companies (10,000 - 40,000 employees) say that they have difficulties to get support from IT leaders. At first this results is confusing because the transformation of the enterprise architecture is initiated and realized by the CIO organization. However the result can be due frustrated business people who have experienced several architectural initiatives in the past that did not really support their specific business needs.
- **Organizational restructuring efforts (18% of all challenges):** Ultimately this is rather a relatively small challenge. Only 25 to 29% of companies that employ up to 40,000 people state organizational restructuring efforts as a challenge when transforming the enterprise architecture. However, 50% of large companies (more than 40,000 employees) see organizational restructuring as a major challenge on the way toward their target state ("to-be") enterprise architecture.

Question II.4: How does enterprise SOA fit in your EA planning?

Graph 8: Enterprise SOA in the context of EA (139 responses)

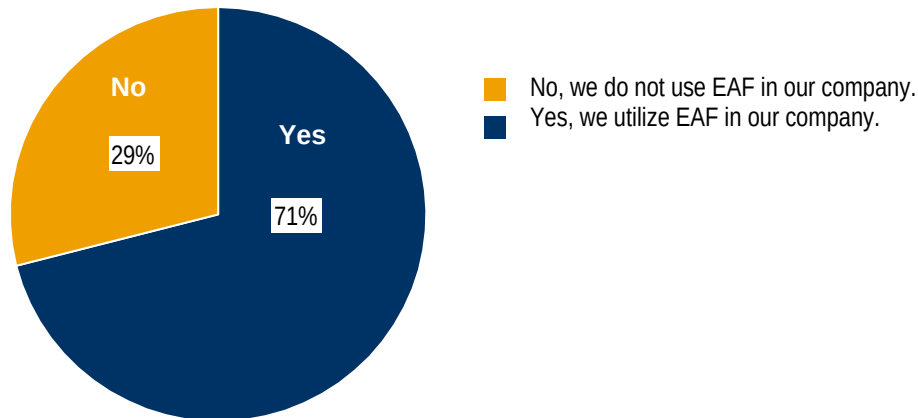
Summary:

- On the one side, more than two third of the participants (67%) assume that enterprise SOA is the right concept toward a flexible and innovative enterprise architecture. There is a basic consent (48%) that loosely-coupled, standardized components are the right way to build mature enterprise architectures. Linking customers, partners and suppliers close to companies' business processes represents a relatively large benefit of 40%.
- On the other side, 32% of the participants are more skeptical and suggest enterprise SOA as one possible architectural blueprint among others. 28% find fault with the technical maturity of the current concept, and less than one-tenth of the participants (9%) basically do not put enterprise SOA on the agenda.
- Beside 30% of the criteria that show that enterprise SOA is not very relevant for companies, 70% of the criteria clearly demonstrate the importance of enterprise SOA.

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III. Enterprise Architecture Framework

Question III.1: Are enterprise architecture frameworks (EAF) used in your company?

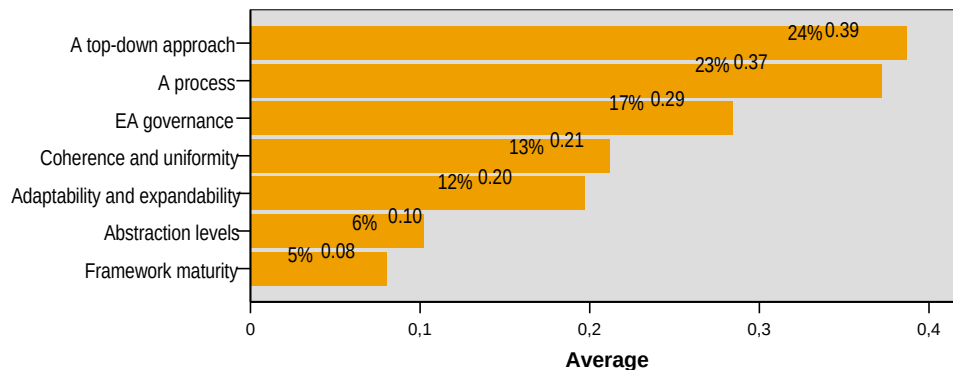


Graph 9: Framework utilization rate (137 responses)

This question determines the general attitude towards enterprise architecture frameworks as a tool to design an enterprise architecture.

Summary:

- Most companies use enterprise architecture frameworks to design their architectures (71%). These companies typically have a mature enterprise architecture program and tightly embed the framework in it. The framework helps to describe enterprise architecture viewpoints systematically and provides guidance for the enterprise architecture process.
- 29% of the participants do not utilize enterprise architecture frameworks in their companies. It is a relative large number of companies; however, this result in one of the reasons why enterprise architecture frameworks are the top content of educational programs for enterprise architects.

Question III.2: Yes, we use EAF and evaluate them by means of following criteria?

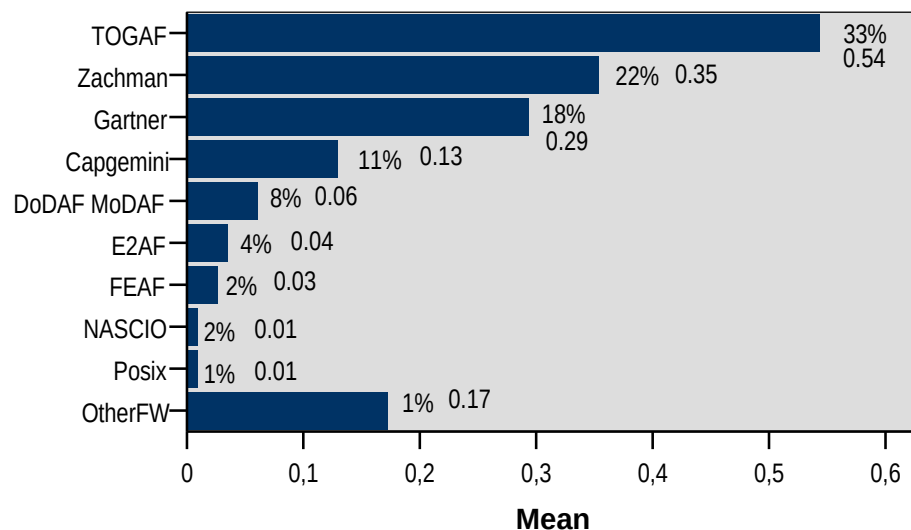
Graph 10: Important criteria when evaluating EA frameworks (97 responses)

The question identifies prioritized features of enterprise architecture frameworks in order to choose the most relevant one(s) amongst them.

Summary:

- A **top-down approach** is a fundamental feature when you compare different enterprise architecture frameworks. This approach helps to derive architectural requirements from the business strategy. The criterion was selected by 39% of the participants and received a relative frequency of 24%.
- A **process** is essential to define a clear roadmap toward the target state enterprise architecture (23%).
- Another important feature for enterprise architecture frameworks is **governance** (17%). Generally IT governance is a significant aspect especially for large organizations with complex organizational structures and distributed IT areas and systems. Without defining roles and procedures for the governance of the enterprise architecture companies run the risk of having overlapping competencies and conflicts of interest.

Other criteria of enterprise architecture frameworks: ready to use frameworks, vendor-specific frameworks, simplification of IT infrastructure and applications and the most common used frameworks.

Question III.3: What are relevant frameworks for your sector?

Graph 11: Importance of enterprise architecture frameworks (108 responses)

31 of 139 participants (22%) did not complete the question about relevant enterprise architecture frameworks. Sometimes they left comments such as 'I don't know' or 'tell me more'.

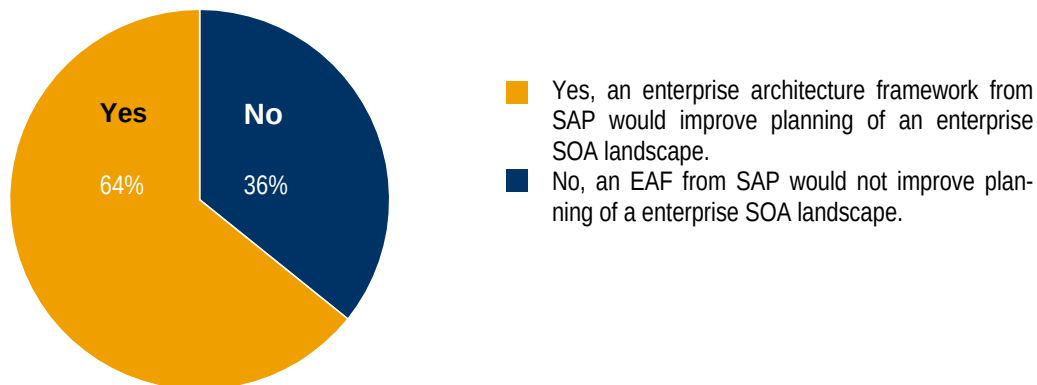
Summary:

The results are obvious if you compare the features of the frameworks such as TOGAF, Zachman and Gartner with criteria critical (e.g. a top-down approach, a process, and the enterprise architecture governance) for evaluating enterprise architecture frameworks.

- **TOGAF** (The Open Group Architecture Framework) is the most popular framework of the participants. It was selected by 54% of the participants and reached a relative frequency of 33%. This vote clearly results from the fulfillment of almost all important criteria to evaluate these frameworks. TOGAF provides a robust advice on architecture governance and is aligned to a process for developing enterprise architecture.
- The **Zachman framework** reached a relative frequency of 22%. The framework is one of the "richest" frameworks in terms of detail.
- **Gartner's** Enterprise Architecture Framework was chosen by 29% of the participants and ranked third having a relative frequency of 18%. This framework explicitly drives architecture out of the business strategy and supports governance by both the framework and the process.

Other frameworks such as Capgemini's framework, DoDAF (Department of Defense Architecture Framework, US), MoDAF (Ministry of Defense Architecture Framework, UK), E2AF, FEAF, NASCIO, NGOSS, NIHEAF, Posix and Spewak were chosen less frequently.

Question III.4: Would an EAF from SAP better enable you to plan your enterprise SOA landscape?



Graph 12: General trend in regard to a framework from SAP (123 responses)

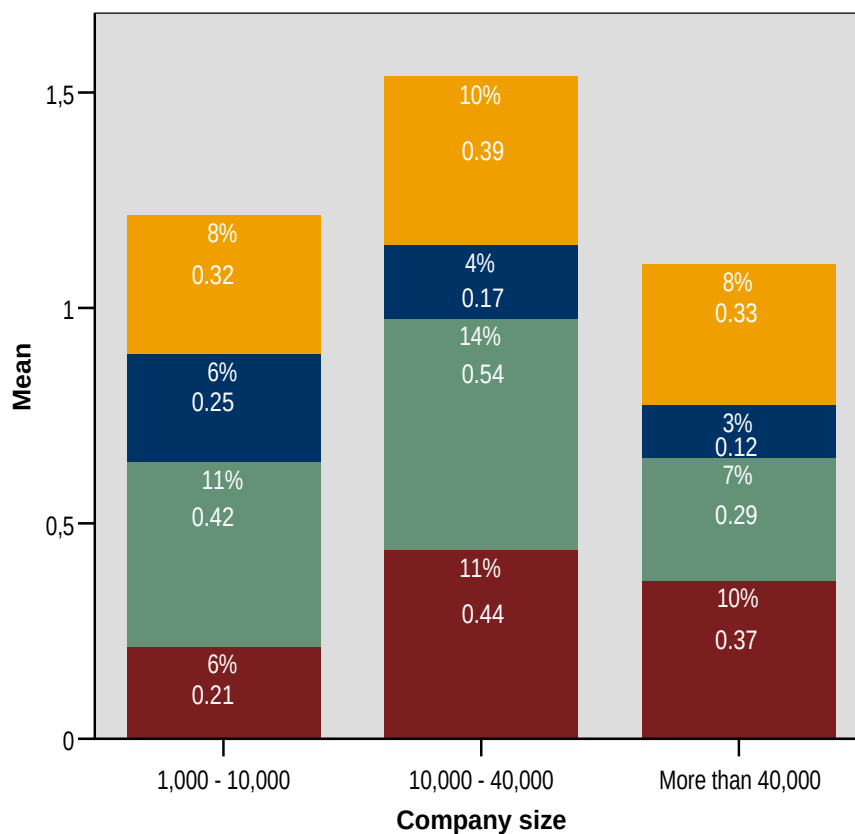
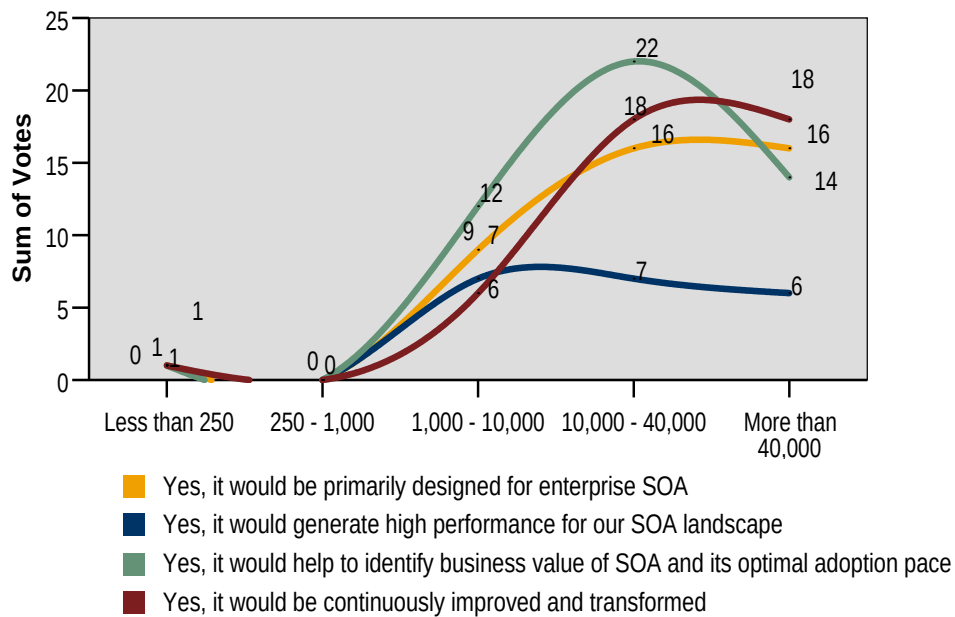
This question wants to identify the general attitude towards such a vendor-specific framework and the reasons for and against it.

Summary:

- On the one hand you can conclude that customers would like an enterprise architecture framework from SAP. About 64% of all participants would appreciate it.
- On the other hand 36% of the participants prefer to combine and “SAP-lisize” their own frameworks.

To better understand and interpret this result, answers are combined to the company size of each participant. Again, there were few survey participants who actually work for companies with less than 1,000 employees. Thus the analysis of this question is only based on votes of larger companies.

Reasons for the first answer “Yes, we would appreciate and EAF from SAP” of the previous question.



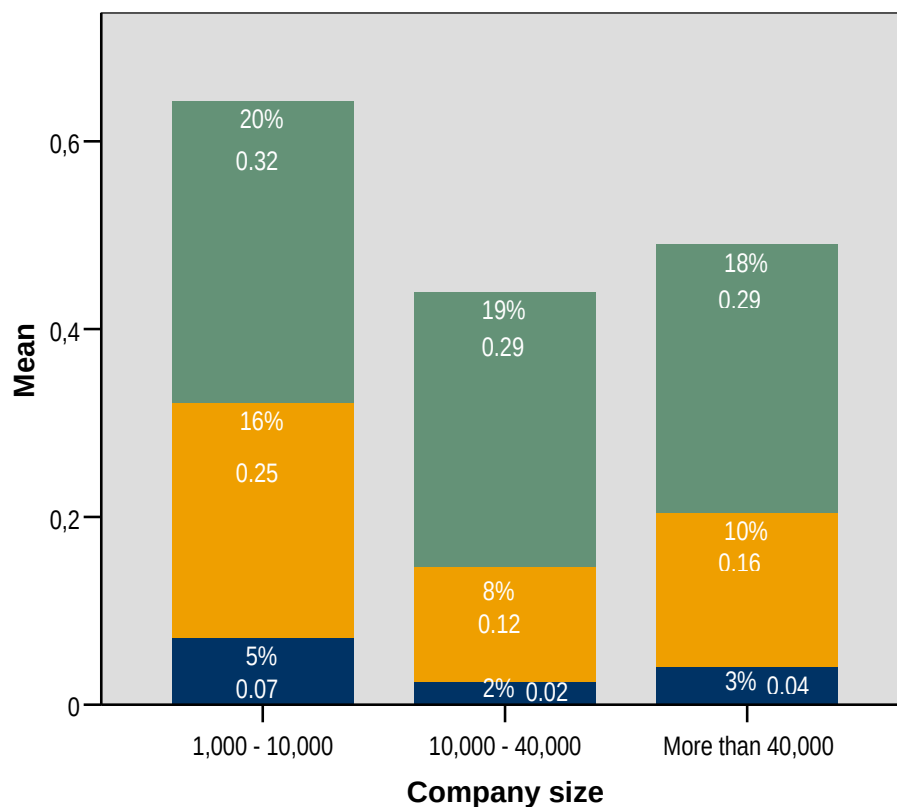
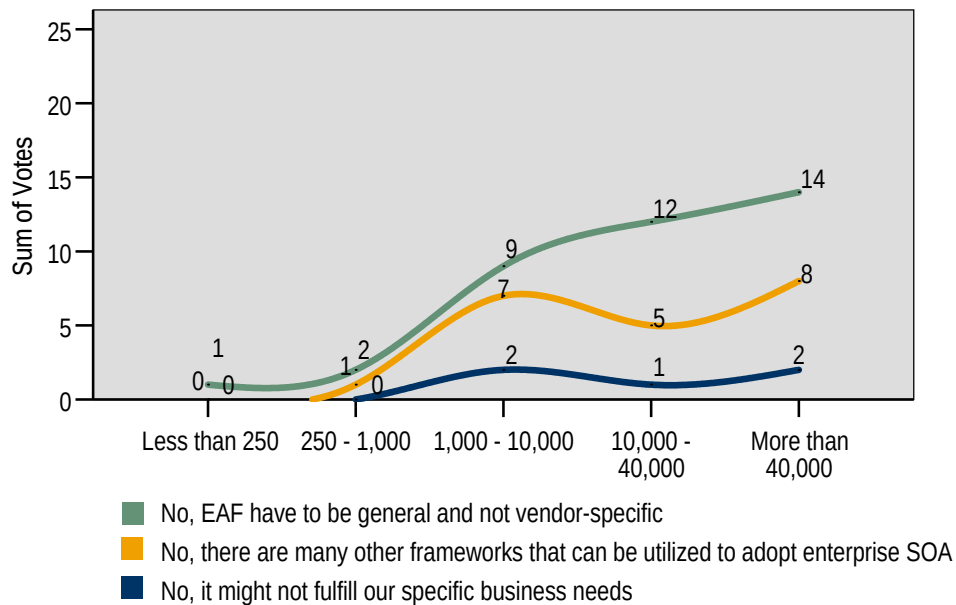
Graph 13: Pro EAF from SAP (79 responses in this group)

Summary (described in a descending order):

- **Identification of the business value of SOA (32%):** This is the strongest benefit participants would expect from a framework designed by SAP. The framework might help them to identify the business value of their SOA and would provide the optimal adoption pace toward a service-enabled system landscape. 54% of participants from companies with 10,000 to 40,000 employees selected this item. However, only 29% (nearly half) of participants from very large companies (more than 40,000 employees) agree with this reason.
- **Primarily designed for enterprise SOA (27%):** An enterprise architecture framework from SAP would strongly support SAP's concept of enterprise SOA. Organizations which have 10,000 to 40,000 employees seem to have the most interest in getting a framework that is primarily designed for enterprise SOA (39%).
- **Continuous improvement and transformation (26%):** SAP is expected to be a trusted partner who would continuously improve the framework. This reason proved less crucial for companies up to 10,000 employees (21%) but almost twice as important for companies up to 40,000 (44%) and more employees (37%)².
- **High-performance for the SOA landscape (14%):** This item was rarely selected and so only reached 14% of all votes given for this question. It felt that a framework from SAP would not automatically increase the performance of the SOA landscape.

² There are de facto some frameworks which are introduced and supported by companies such as Hewlett Packard or Capgemini. Source: http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Enterprise_Architecture#Enterprise_architecture_frameworks.

Reasons for the second answer “No, we would not utilize an EAF from SAP” of the previous question.



Graph 14: Reasons against an EAF from SAP (44 responses in this group)

Summary (described in a descending order):

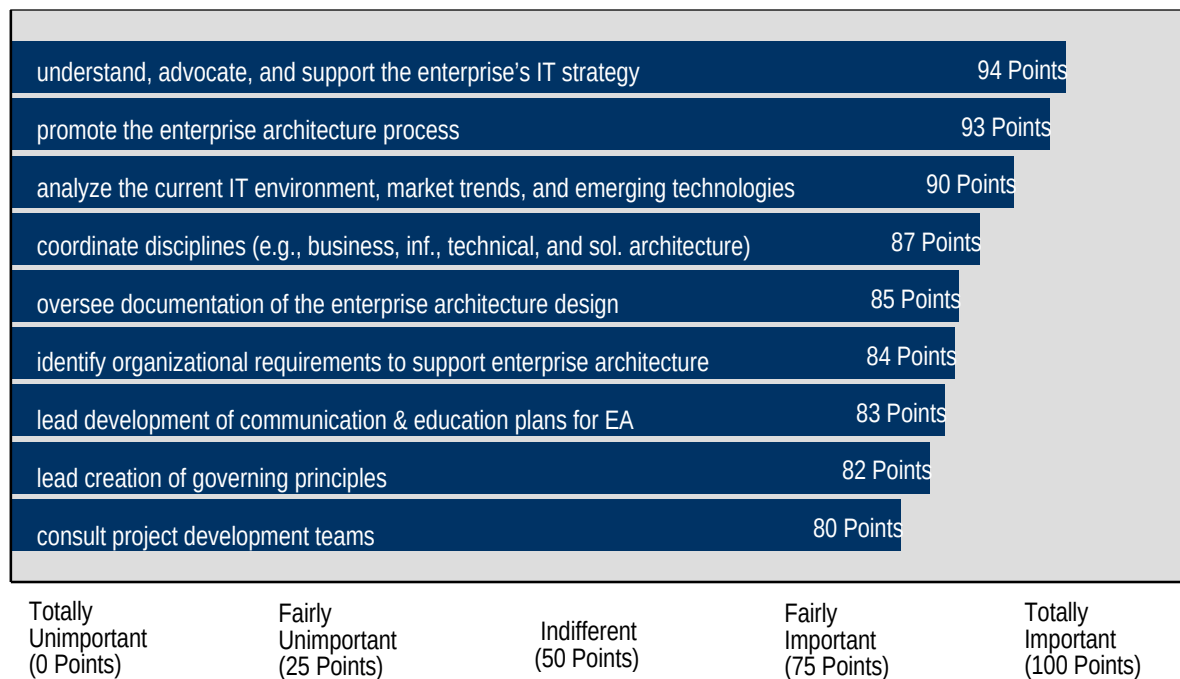
- **An EAF must be general and not vendor-specific (57%):** 30% of participants on average avoid using frameworks that are proprietary. They fear such a framework might link their architecture too close to products of vendors.
- **There are many other frameworks (34%):** As there are other frameworks which can be utilized free of charge this is basically a stronger reason for companies with 1,000 to 10,000 employees (25%) than for larger companies (12% and 16%).
- **Such a framework would not meet our specific business needs (9%):** This is the weakest reason against a framework from SAP. However, 7% of participants from companies with 1,000 to 10,000 employees think that such a framework could hinder them in meeting their real business needs.

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IV. Role of the Enterprise Architect

Question IV.1: What are responsibilities of enterprise architects?

Enterprise architects ...



Graph 15: Responsibilities of enterprise architects (137 responses)

Summary:

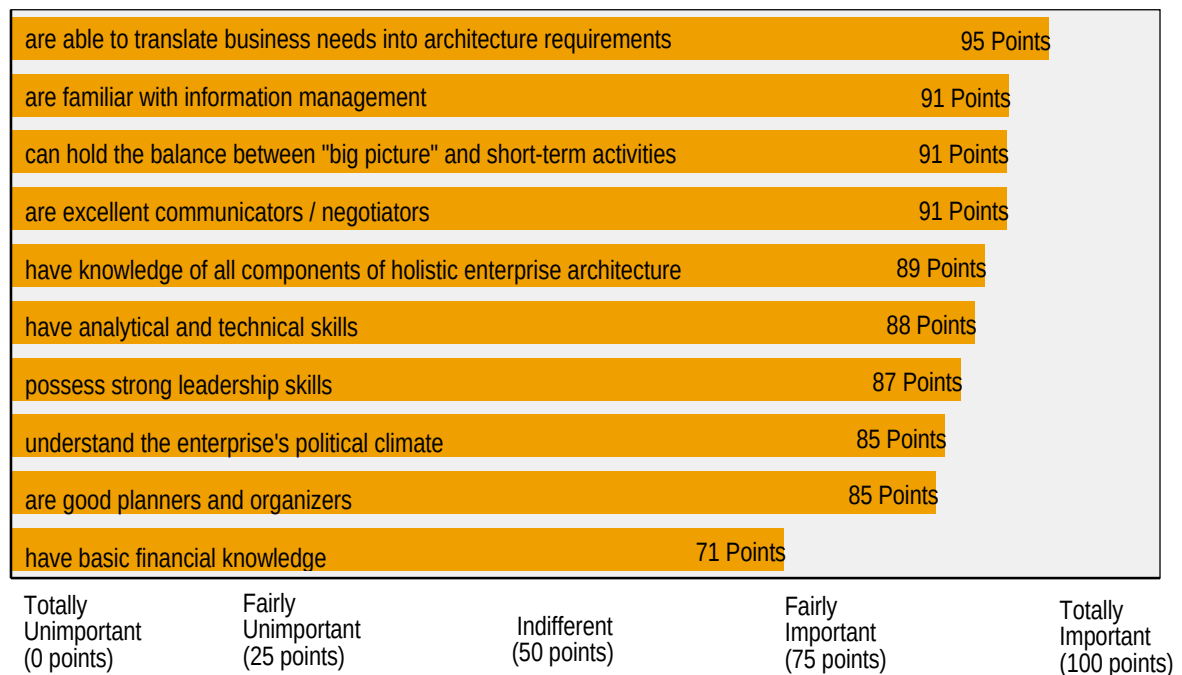
As the diagram illustrates that enterprise architects are responsible for a broad range of tasks.

- It's highly important for enterprise architects to understand, advocate and support the enterprise's IT strategy (94 points).
- Another key responsibility for enterprise architects is the promotion of the enterprise architecture process (93 points).
- Analyzing current IT environment, market trends, and emerging technologies reached the third place (90 points).
- Enterprise architects also coordinate disciplines like business, information, technical and solution architecture (87 points); oversee documentation of the enterprise architecture (85 points); identify organizational requirements to support the enterprise architecture (84 points); lead the development of communications and education plans (83 points); lead the creation of governance principles (82 points); and consult project development teams (80 points).

Others responsibilities: create business value, simplification, ROI, TCO, train new enterprise architects, promote the composition and services to support BPM, participate in enterprise decision-making, save business strategy.

Question IV.2: What skills are essential for enterprise architects?

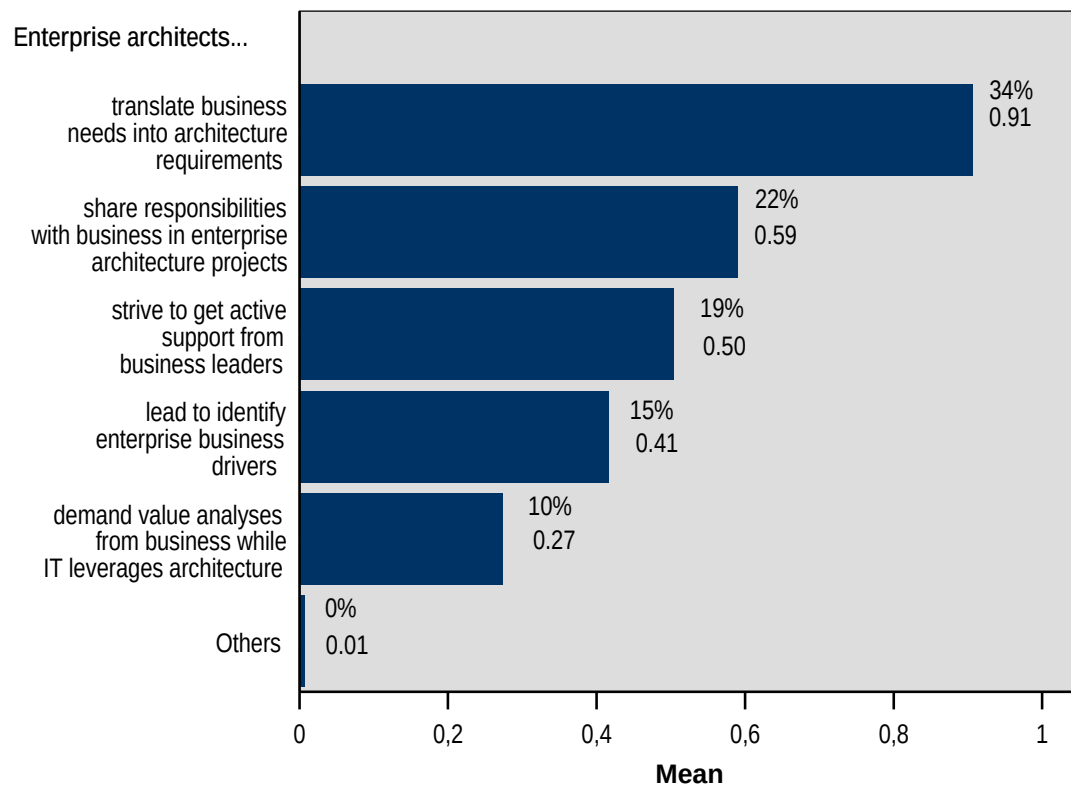
Enterprise architects ...



Graph 16: Most important skills of enterprise architects (138 responses)

Summary:

- Enterprise architects must be skilled and experienced in translating business needs into architectural requirements (95 points).
- They must be familiar with information management (91 points).
- They must always hold the right balance between the 'big picture' and short-term activities when they lead the enterprise architecture program (91 points).

Question IV.3: How do enterprise architects interact with business?

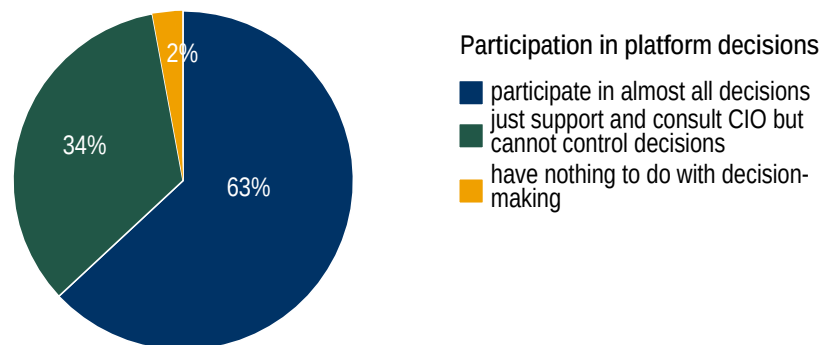
Graph 17: Interaction types of enterprise architects with business (139 responses)

This question examines the way enterprise architects actively contribute to bridge the gap between business and IT.

Summary:

- More than 90% in average say that enterprise architects interact with business by translating business needs into architectural requirements.
- Enterprise architects are not alone in their responsibility for the success of architectural projects. They share responsibilities with business people to achieve a sustainable value from the architecture (selected by 59% of the participants).
- Enterprise architects also strive to get active support from business leaders (selected by 50% of the participants). At the same time this activity possesses a serious challenge for enterprise architects (see question II.2, part 2).

Beyond the competencies of enterprise architects in architectural issues it's an exciting question how far their power actually extends into platform decisions.

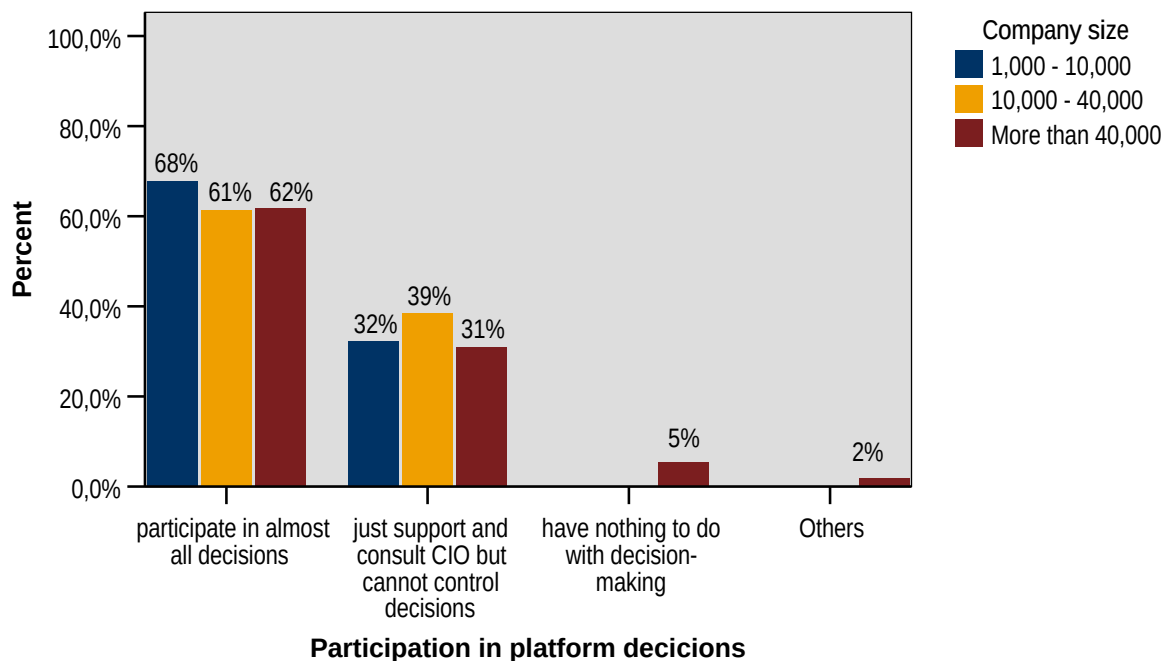
Question IV.4: Do enterprise architects participate in platform decisions? - Part 1

Graph 18: Participation types of EAs in platform decisions (138 responses)

Summary:

- Since the main characteristic of enterprise architecture is to support the decision-making process (see II.1) enterprise architects are strong contributors and participants in decisions around the platform (63%).
- Only 34% say that enterprise architects just support and consult the CIO, and that they cannot control decisions.
- Very few say that enterprise architects have nothing to do with decision-making (2%).

Others: Enterprise architects try to influence and place decisions that support the business direction.

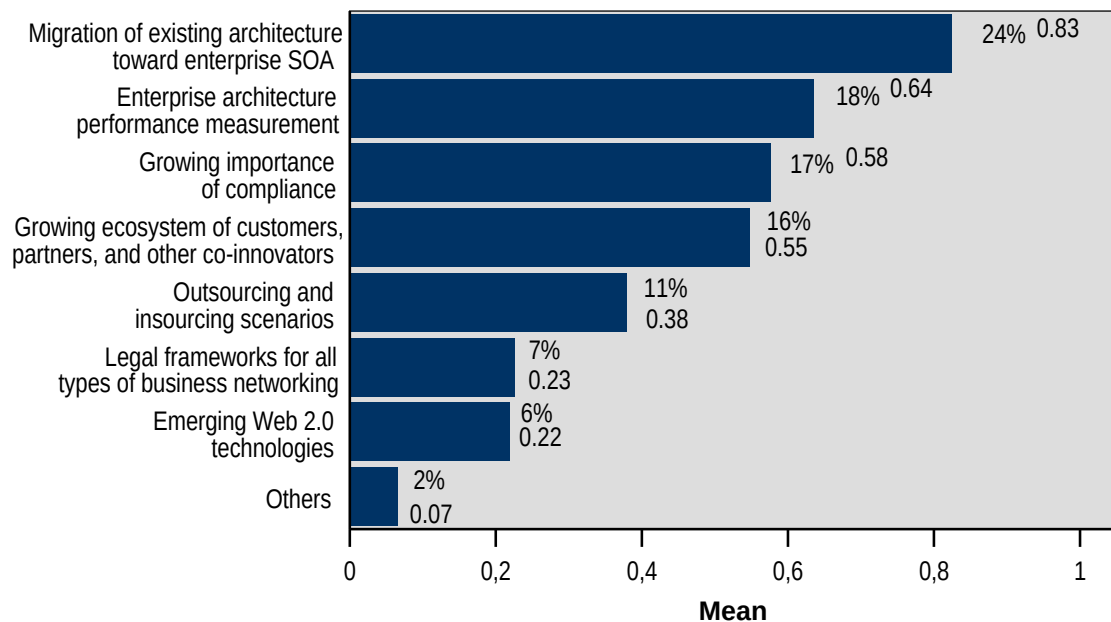
Question IV.4: Do enterprise architects participate in platform decisions?- Part 2

Graph 19: Participation in platform decisions (138 responses)

To better interpret these results the participation types are compared to the appropriate company size of each participant (graph 19). Again, small companies with less than 1,000 employees are disregarded due to few votes in this segment.

Summary:

- In general, there are similar results (distribution) for the participation types over the different company sizes. 61% to 68% say that enterprise architects participate in almost all platform decisions while 31% to 39% say that enterprise architects just support but cannot control those decisions.
- But it seems that in 5% of the large companies (more than 40,000 employees) enterprise architects lose their power to actively participate and contribute in platform decisions.

Question IV.5: What are challenges for enterprise architects in future?

Graph 20: Future challenges for enterprise architects (137 responses)

The question intends to capture the feelings of various visionary trends and technologies and wants to identify the impacts on the role of enterprise architects.

Summary:

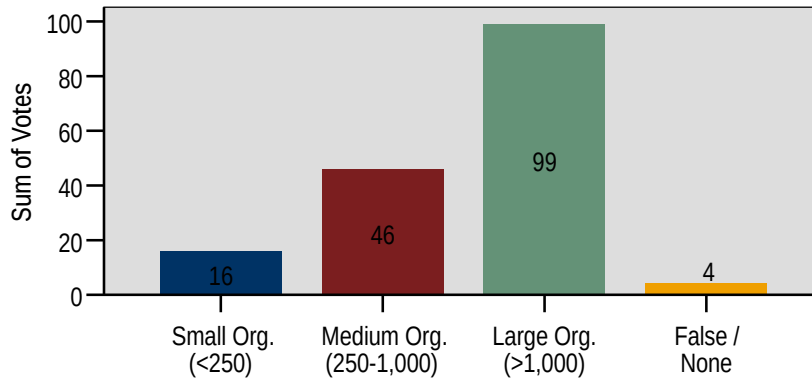
- 83% of the participants expect that enterprise architects will be mainly in demand to migrate the existing architecture toward an enterprise service-oriented architecture (24%).
- Enterprise architecture performance measurement may be the second big challenge in future (18%).
- Furthermore enterprise architects may become more responsible for monitoring and controlling the state of the architecture program (17%).

Others challenges may be the global business growth, the balance between cost reduction and architectural improvement, commercial electronic services, the migration from traditional IT governance towards enterprise SOA governance, the proliferation of the enterprise architecture in an organization, the role of business transformation processes, architecting for a multi-vendor environment, and finally “surviving” the workload in an environment of rapid change.

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V. Organizational Structure

Question V.1: *How important are chief enterprise architects as leaders of the enterprise architecture team for small, medium, and large organization?*



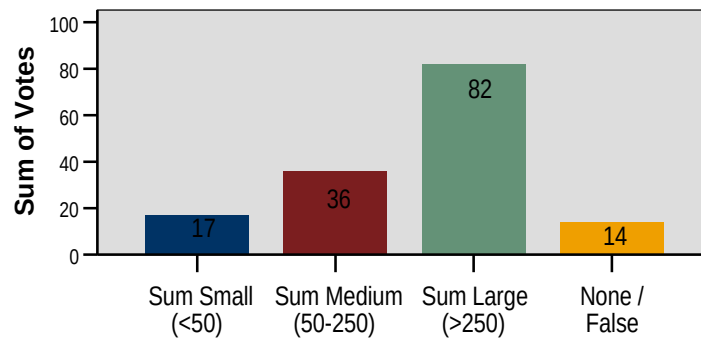
Graph 21: The importance of enterprise architects (112 responses)

The question (multiple answers were possible) wants to rate the importance of enterprise architects dependent of the company sizes.

Summary:

- Enterprise architects primarily lead the enterprise architecture team in larger companies (99 votes).
- Small and mid-sized companies typically utilize lightweight approaches to enterprise architecture which means that the responsibilities of the enterprise architect is often assumed by other roles such as the CIO, the CTO, etc.

This question (multiple answers were possible, too) wants to find out if architecture teams, independent of their individual size, include virtual team members who have subject-matter expertise.

Question V.2: Are there virtual team members in the enterprise architecture team?

Graph 22: Virtual team members in the EA team (110 responses)

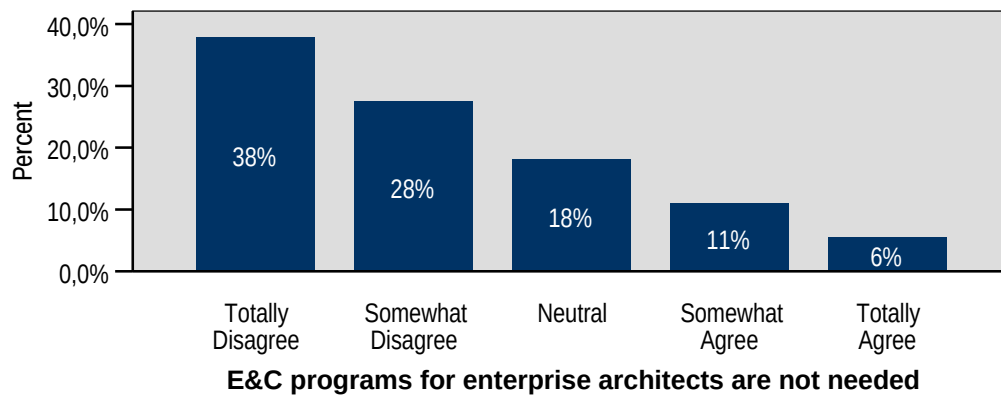
Summary:

- Virtual team members are rarely involved in architectural projects of small companies (17 votes).
- Large organizations often have virtual team members in their architecture projects (82 votes). Common virtual team members include application and solution developers, network specialists, security professionals, infrastructure designers, and senior IT operations staff.

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VI. Education and Certification for Enterprise Architects

Question VI.1: Education and certification programs are not needed?

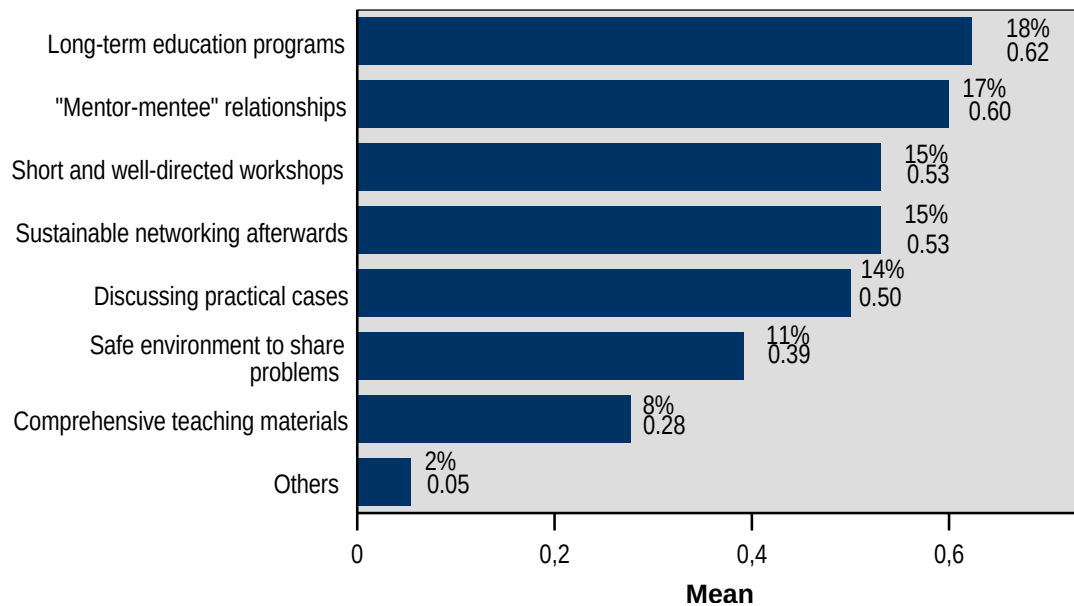


Graph 23: Education and certification programs in general (127 responses)

This direct question wants to identify the necessity of education and certification programs for enterprise architects.

Summary:

Apart from 18% of neutral votes there are 65% who are convinced that such programs are helpful, and 17% who think those programs are not necessary.

Question VI.2: What's the best way to educate enterprise architects?

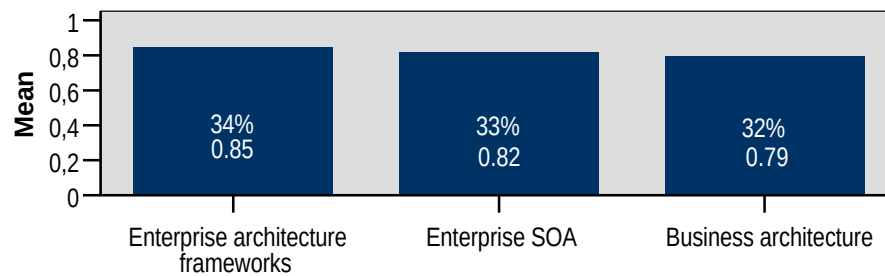
Graph 24: The best ways to educate enterprise architects (130 responses)

This question is used to assess different approaches of education programs for enterprise architects.

Summary:

- Education programs need to be a combination of long-term programs (18%) and short, well-directed workshops (15%). In addition these programs should be characterized by "mentor-mentee" relationships (17%).
- Other ways to educate enterprise architects: on the job rotation of the architecture roles.

Question VI.3: What could be contents of education programs for enterprise architects?

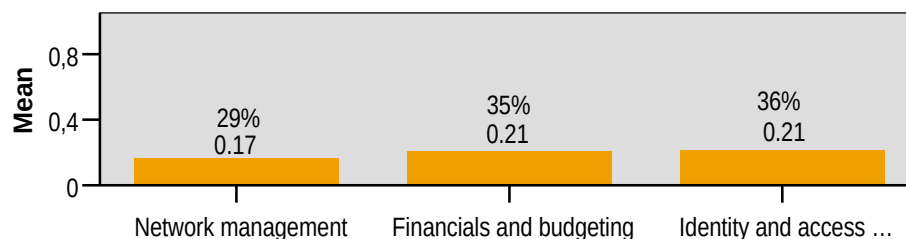


Graph 25: Important contents of education programs (131 responses)

Summary:

- The three most important content areas are enterprise architecture frameworks (selected by 85% of all participants), enterprise SOA (selected by 82% of the participants), and the enterprise business architecture (selected by 79%).

Question VI.4: What could be contents of education programs for enterprise architects?

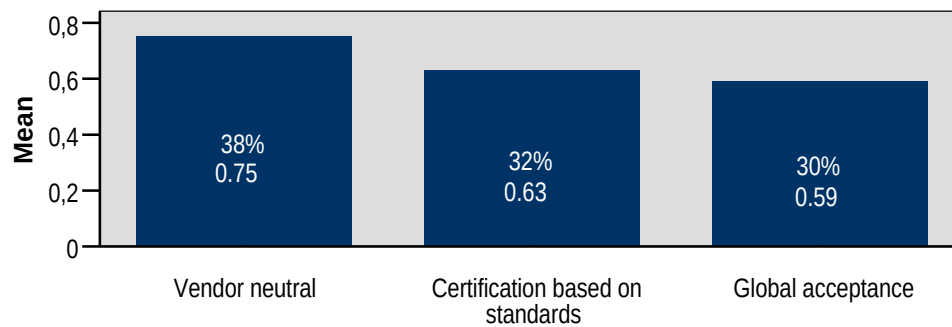


Graph 26: Unimportant contents of education programs (131 responses)

Summary:

- Network management (17%), financial and budgeting (21%), as well as identity and access management (21%) were rarely selected by the participants.

Question VI.5: What features are important of a certification program for enterprise architects?



Graph 27: Important features of certification programs (130 responses)

Summary:

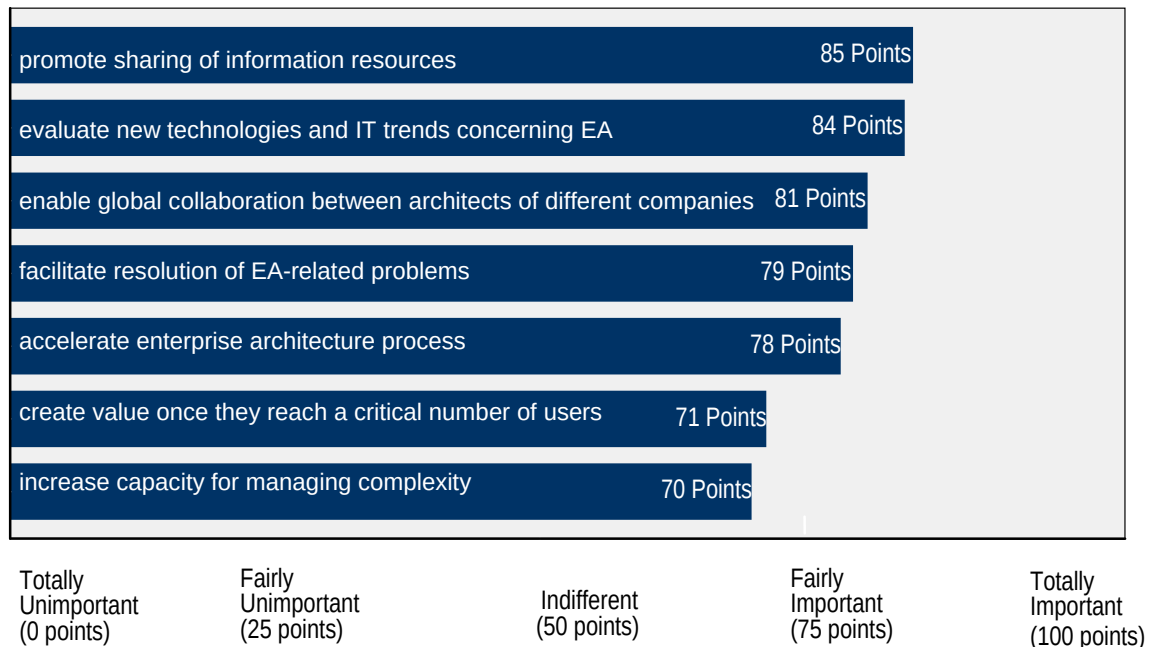
- 75% of all participants say that a certification program for enterprise architects should be vendor neutral. Enterprise architects do not want to become too focused on vendor-dependent methodologies and solutions.
- Very important for certification programs are standards (63%). Enterprise architects do not want to get certified in proprietary technology.
- Another crucial feature is the global acceptance of certification programs (59%).

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VII. Communities for Enterprise Architects

Question VII.1: How important are communities for enterprise architects?

Communities for enterprise architects ...



Graph 28: Importance of communities for enterprise architects (135 responses)

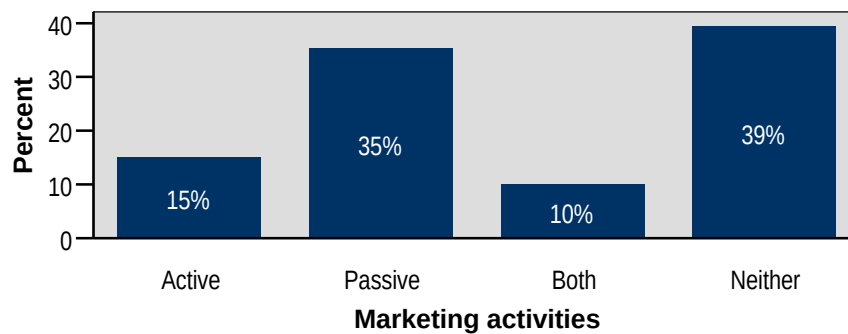
The question examines how necessary communities are for the business work of enterprise architects in general.

Summary:

- Communities for enterprise architects are mainly used to share information (85 points).
- But communities also provide a platform to evaluate new technologies and IT trends concerning enterprise architectures (84 points).
- In addition, communities enable global collaborations between enterprise architects (81 points).

Since communities can only work effectively if there is an active interest in them, the following diagrams present different levels of participation in multiple activities.

Question VII.2: What might be your participation for marketing activities in an EA community?

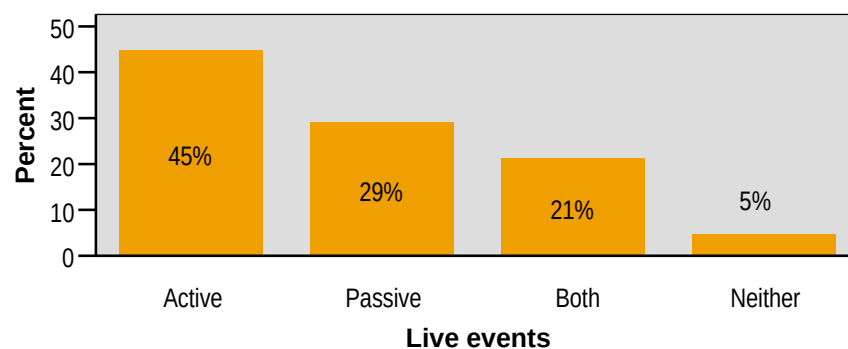


Graph 29: Participation in marketing activities (119 responses)

Summary:

- Marketing activities (e.g. architectural campaigns) are not the core purpose of communities for enterprise architects. Only 15% would actively participate in marketing activities.

Question VII.3: What might be your participation for live events in an EA community?

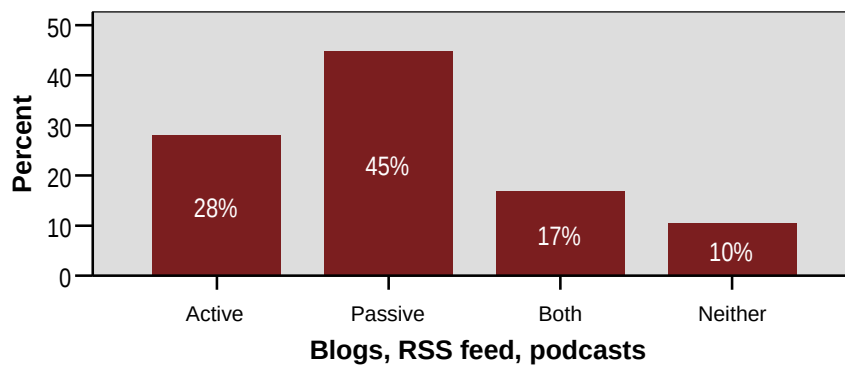


Graph 30: Participation in live events (119 responses)

Summary:

- Live events such as conferences, web seminars, and conference calls would be very popular in architectural communities. 45% would actively participate in these events. So there is a strong interest recognizable. Only 5% of the participants dislike participating in these activities both actively and passively.

Question VII.4: What might be your participation in an EA community for blogs, RSS feeds, and podcasts?

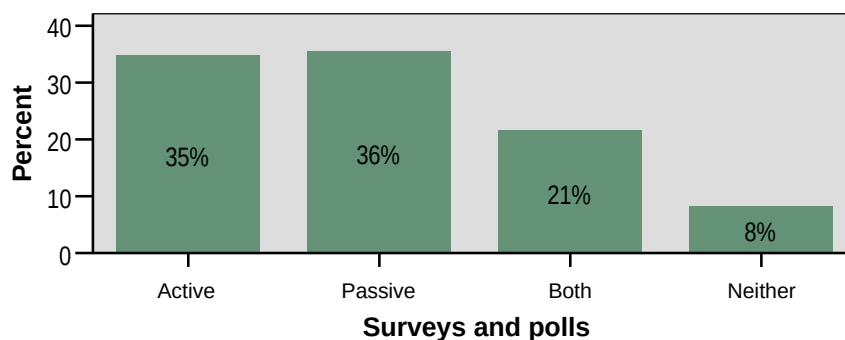


Graph 31: Participation in blogs, RSS feeds and podcasts (125 responses)

Summary:

- Blogs, RSS feeds, and podcasts are other ways to share information. Participants prefer to use these technologies passively (45%). 10% of the participants are against these (modern) ways of information sharing.

Question VII.5: What might be your participation in an EA community for surveys and polls?



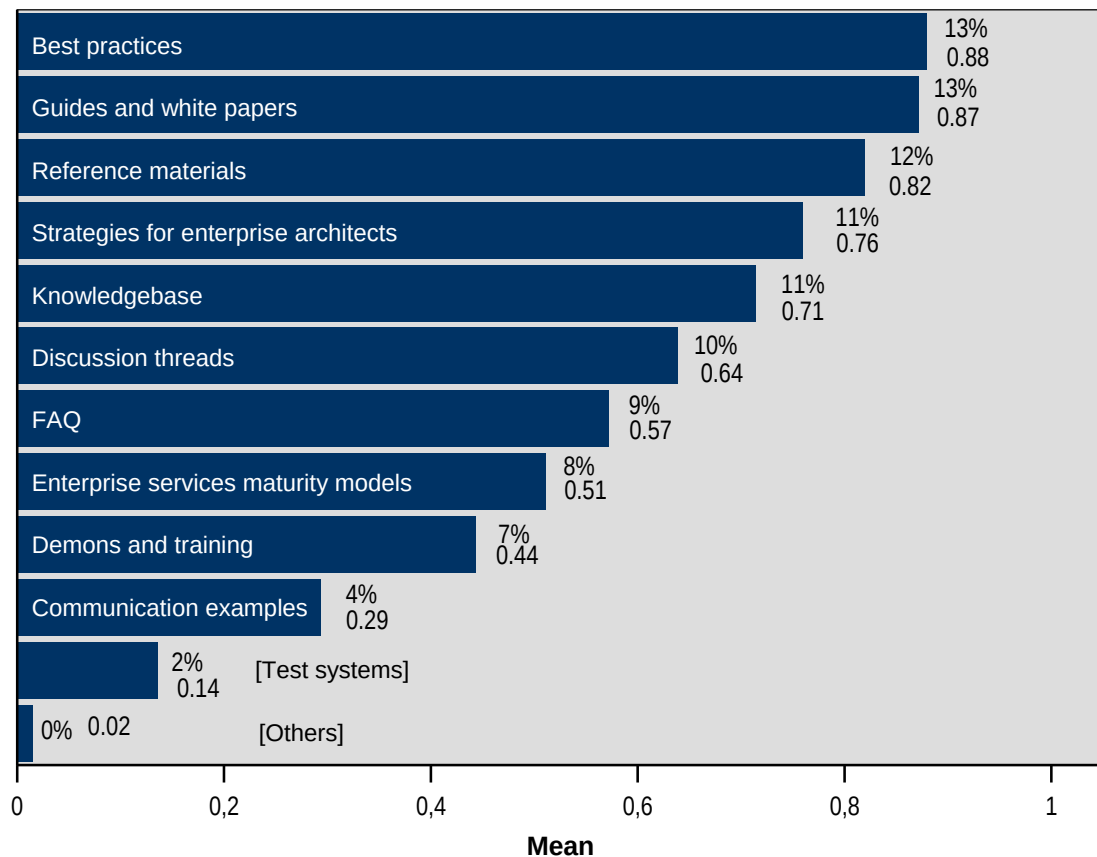
Graph 32: Participation in surveys and polls (121 responses)

Summary:

- Surveys and polls are quite helpful tools if you need to find out the opinions of your community members in regard to specific topics. People are motivated to participate both actively and passively in those activities.

Communities, especially like these for enterprise architects, must produce value. Otherwise, members do not want to invest time and money anymore. So communities must provide the right deliverables for their members.

Question VII.6: What are important deliverables of a community for enterprise architects?



Graph 33: Important community deliverables (133 responses)

Summary:

- About 88% of all participants chose **best practices** as the most important deliverable of communities for enterprise architects. Compared to other deliverables this represents 13%.
- Knowledge and experiences related to enterprise architecture should be summarized in **guides and white papers** (selected by 87% of the participants).
- A third important deliverable is **reference materials** (chosen by 82% of the participants) such as reference architectures. These reusable assets are very useful for companies because they lower the complexity of future projects, make it possible to realize them in shorter periods of time, and finally improve the quality of the architecture.

The least important deliverables of a community for enterprise architects are test systems (2%), communication examples (4%), as well as demos and training materials (7%). Other deliverables proposed by the participants are success stories and networking sessions.